Part VIII

Assessment, Rubrics, and Professional Standards

> *"Assessment should measure the quality of strategic thinking rather than the quantity of information remembered."*

Philosophy of Assessment

Assessment in this course is designed to evaluate students' ability to think, communicate, and lead strategically in environments increasingly shaped by artificial intelligence. Rather than emphasizing memorization of strategic frameworks, the course measures students' ability to analyze ambiguous organizational problems, synthesize multiple theoretical perspectives, evaluate evidence, formulate defensible recommendations, and communicate effectively with executive audiences.

Assessment is developmental. Students begin the semester by mastering foundational concepts and progressively demonstrate higher-order competencies through application, integration, evaluation, and creation. By the end of the course, students should be capable of producing work comparable to that expected of a junior management consultant or corporate strategy analyst.

The assessment system is aligned with the Course Learning Outcomes, the AI Strategy Evolution Framework (AISE), and Bloom's Revised Taxonomy. Every major assignment contributes to the semester consulting engagement, ensuring that learning activities reinforce one another rather than existing as isolated exercises.

Assessment Structure

Assessment Component	**Weight**	**Primary Learning Outcomes**
Class Participation and Executive Discussion	10%	CLO 1, CLO 4, CLO 7
Weekly Theory Evolution Exercises	15%	CLO 3, CLO 5, CLO 9
Harvard Business School Case Analyses	15%	CLO 1, CLO 3, CLO 5
AI Strategy Laboratories	20%	CLO 2, CLO 3, CLO 6, CLO 8
Semester AI Strategy Consulting Project	25%	CLO 1–10
Executive Board Presentation	10%	CLO 7, CLO 8, CLO 10
Professionalism and Reflection Portfolio	5%	CLO 4, CLO 6, CLO 10

Assessment Philosophy

Every major assignment is evaluated according to five overarching dimensions.

1. **Analytical Rigor** — Is the analysis theoretically grounded and logically structured?
2. **Strategic Insight** — Does the work identify meaningful strategic implications?
3. **Evidence Quality** — Are recommendations supported by scholarly and organizational evidence?
4. **Professional Communication** — Is the work suitable for an executive audience?
5. **Responsible AI Use** — Is AI employed transparently, critically, and ethically?

Universal Executive Rubric

The following rubric applies, with assignment-specific modifications, to all major written and oral assessments.

Criterion	Exemplary (A)	Proficient (B)	Developing (C)	Beginning (D/F)
Strategic Analysis	Demonstrates exceptional diagnosis using multiple strategic frameworks with insightful integration.	Applies appropriate frameworks with minor gaps in depth or integration.	Uses frameworks inconsistently or superficially.	Analysis lacks strategic coherence or appropriate theoretical application.
Theoretical Integration	Integrates classical and AI scholarship seamlessly and accurately.	Demonstrates sound understanding with moderate integration.	Limited integration of theory and AI literature.	Minimal or inaccurate use of theory.
Evidence and Research	Uses high-quality scholarly and practitioner sources to support all claims.	Evidence generally supports conclusions with minor weaknesses.	Evidence is incomplete or weakly connected to recommendations.	Recommendations are largely unsupported.
Strategic Judgment	Recommendations are innovative, feasible, and well justified.	Recommendations are appropriate but could be more thoroughly defended.	Recommendations are generic or insufficiently justified.	Recommendations are unclear, impractical, or unsupported.
Executive Communication	Writing and presentation are clear, persuasive, concise, and appropriate for senior leaders.	Communication is generally effective with minor issues.	Communication lacks clarity or executive focus.	Communication is difficult to follow or unprofessional.

Assignment Rubrics

Theory Evolution Exercises

Students complete ten short essays responding to the prompt:

> **"If I were rewriting this classical theory in 2026, I would..."**

Evaluation Criteria:

- Understanding of the original theory (20%)
- Identification of underlying assumptions (20%)
- Analysis of AI's impact (25%)
- Original theoretical insight (20%)
- Writing quality and scholarly support (15%)

Harvard Business School Case Analyses

Students prepare executive memoranda analyzing assigned cases.

Evaluation Criteria:

- Organizational diagnosis
- Application of strategic theory
- Integration of AI implications
- Quality of recommendations
- Executive writing style

AI Strategy Laboratories

Laboratories emphasize disciplined use of AI rather than prompt engineering.

Evaluation Criteria:

- Appropriate use of AI tools
- Verification of AI-generated outputs
- Integration of scholarly evidence
- Strategic reasoning
- Reflection on AI limitations

Students are expected to document AI interactions and explain how AI informed—but did not determine—their recommendations.

Semester AI Strategy Consulting Project

The consulting project is evaluated holistically using the AI Strategy Evolution Framework.

AISE Stage	Evaluation Focus
Strategic Diagnosis	Industry and competitive analysis
Capability Assessment	Organizational resources and AI readiness
AI Opportunity Identification	Strategic value creation
Strategic Choice	Quality of strategic alternatives
Governance & Risk	Responsible AI framework
Organizational Transformation	Implementation roadmap
Continuous Learning	Performance measurement and renewal

Additional consideration is given to the integration of strategic theory, AI scholarship, and executive decision making across all seven stages.

Executive Board Presentation

Teams present their consulting recommendations to a simulated Board of Directors.

Evaluation Criteria:

- Executive presence
- Strategic clarity
- Integration of evidence
- Ability to defend recommendations
- Response to board questions
- Visual communication
- Team coordination

Professional Standards

Students are expected to demonstrate the standards associated with management consulting and executive leadership.

Professional expectations include:

- Timely completion of assignments.
- Preparation for class discussions.
- Respectful engagement with peers.
- Accurate citation of sources.
- Honest disclosure of AI use.
- Evidence-based reasoning.
- Professional writing and presentation.
- Ethical decision making.

Responsible Use of Artificial Intelligence

Artificial intelligence is an approved learning partner throughout the course. Students may use AI to support brainstorming, literature exploration, editing, comparative analysis, and scenario development.

However, all submitted work must represent the student's independent intellectual contribution.

Students are expected to:

- Verify AI-generated information.
- Cite scholarly sources rather than AI outputs.
- Disclose substantive AI assistance.
- Exercise independent judgment.
- Critically evaluate AI recommendations.

Failure to verify AI-generated information or presenting AI-generated work as original scholarship constitutes a violation of academic integrity.

Feedback and Continuous Improvement

Assessment is intended to support learning rather than merely assign grades.

Students receive:

- Formative feedback on weekly deliverables.
- Structured feedback on consulting milestones.
- Peer feedback during presentations.
- Opportunities for reflection and revision.

The semester consulting project is intentionally iterative. Students are encouraged to incorporate feedback throughout the term, mirroring the continuous improvement process used in professional consulting engagements.

Assurance of Learning

The assessment system provides direct evidence of student achievement for all Course Learning Outcomes. Multiple assessments evaluate each learning outcome, ensuring that competencies are demonstrated in diverse contexts and through authentic performance tasks.

The combination of scholarly writing, case analysis, AI laboratories, consulting deliverables, and executive presentations reflects the multifaceted nature of strategic leadership in AI-enabled organizations.

By the conclusion of the course, successful students will have demonstrated not only mastery of strategic management concepts but also the analytical rigor, technological literacy, ethical judgment, and executive communication skills required to lead organizations through technological transformation.

The assessment system is therefore intended not only to evaluate learning but also to cultivate the habits of inquiry, evidence-based reasoning, and professional responsibility that characterize effective strategic leaders.